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**SIDE EFFECTS**  
 A fever and a local reaction are normal after BCG. A small tender red swelling appears at the site of the injection, which gradually changes to a small vesicle and then an ulcer in 2-4 weeks. The reaction usually subsides within two to five months and in practically all children leaves a superficial scar 2-10 mm in diameter. Rarely, the nodule may persist and ulcerate. Occasionally, enlargement of axillary lymph nodes may appear in 2-4 months following immunization. Very rarely, enlarged lymph nodes can suppurate. Inadvertent subcutaneous injection may produce abscess formation and may lead to scarring. Shock or anaphylaxis may appear. Although anaphylaxis is very rare, the subjects should be observed for an allergic reaction after BCG. Very rarely, systemic disseminated BCG-infection, including osteitis or osteomyelitis, may appear, especially in persons with primary or secondary immunodeficiencies. Expert advice should be sought regarding the appropriate treatment regimen with selected anti-tuberculosis drugs for the management of systemic infections.

**CONTRAINDICATIONS**  
 Keloid and lupoid reactions may also occur at the site of injection and children experiencing such reactions should not be revaccinated. Do not give in pregnancy.

Immune deficiency  
 The vaccine is contraindicated in individuals with cell-mediated immune deficiency.  
**Individuals known to be infected with human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), either non-symptomatic or symptomatic, should NOT receive BCG vaccine.**

**STORAGE**  
 BCG vaccine should be stored and transported between +2°C and +8°C. It is even more stable if stored in temperatures as low as -20°C. The diluent should not be frozen. The vaccine should be protected from the light. Vaccine ampoules and diluents should be transported together. The expiry is specified on the BCG ampoule label.

**PRESENTATION**  
 The vaccine comes in boxes of 10 ampoules or 100 ampoules each containing 0.5mg BCG (moisture weight). The diluent in boxes of 10 ampoules or 100 ampoules each containing 1.0ml physiological saline accompanies all orders.

**REFERENCES**  
 1. Quality Control of freeze-dried BCG vaccine from Japan BCG Laboratory, Tokyo, Japan, 1994/1995, Dr. J. Milstien, WHO Vaccine Supply and Quality, 1996.  
 2. The Thermostability of Different BCG Products, K.Bunch-Christensen, Chief, BCG Department, Statens Seruminstitut, Copenhagen, WHO Collaborating Centre for BCG Vaccine; WHO/TB/81.118, 1981.

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